Linothorax
This composite armour, prevalent in the 5th century BCE, was made of hemp and was constructed by layering linen together, probably between 16 to 20 layers thick, and may have been built with a leather core. The numerous layers effectively staggered the impact of a projectile as it ripped into the cloth.

Ptergues – flaps of linen end at top of the thigh

Unglazed clay

Water bottles
In a simple, yet very effective, system water seeped gradually through the unglazed clay of the bottle and evaporated, cooling the contents.

GREAVES (LEG ARMOUR)

Greaves and sandals
Using a method now lost, the Greeks made bronze flexible to cling around the leg. Muscle shapes were added for strength and aesthetic reasons. Shoes were open even in cold climes.

Laces strapped around leg and tied at the knee

Spike for penetrating armour

Wooden shaft

Axe
The standard hoplite axe is made of bronze. Bronze, although stronger than iron, had the disadvantage of having to be recast if broken.

Bronze pommel

Wooden grip

Xiphos (sword)
The iron blade of the *xiphos* was narrow-waisted toward the handle and heavily weighted at the lower part of the blade to enable a hacking motion over the top of the shield.

Narrow waist

Aspis (shield)
The scorpion on the shield is a Spartan symbol of the city of Geronthrae. This might have been seen at the Battle of Thermopylae.